



Did you know that Youtube supports high-definition content?



HDMI with optical boosting can transmit video and audio to over 100 meters

TOOLBOX

access additional functions such as bookmarks, aspect ratios and quality settings for the video playback. The backspace key takes control back to the previous root menu. So once you have the movie and music folders setup, XBMC automatically takes you to those folders. To add new folders or change settings, one must go back to the root. In every menu, the right-click button on the keyboard (alternate menu key on the keyboard; to the left of the right Ctrl key) or the right-click button on the mouse brings up a menu of alternate functions such as removing media from the database.

Using the File Manager

Almost all the media played using XBMC is done by first adding the source and then playing it from the respective folders. The file manager lets you play any file format directly from the file location itself. To go to the file manager, go to the main menu if you are using a default theme and go to File Manager. With MediaStream, the file manager can be accessed through Configure the System menu. The File Manager has two paths on either side and additional paths such as network paths can be added by selecting Add Source. A display of the system resources can also be seen in this menu. File operations can be performed by right-clicking in this menu or by using the alternate-click key on the keyboard. Files and folders can be deleted and renamed using this feature. This feature is especially useful as it removes the need for using Windows to make changes to the folder structure and also for quickly running isolated media files without having to import them every time to the XBMC library.

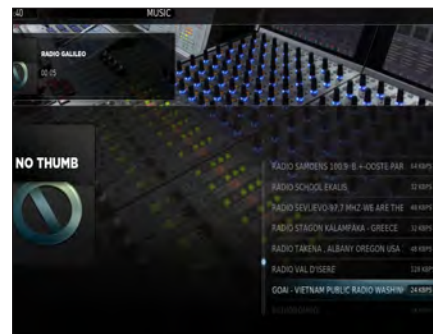
Streaming audio from the internet

The advantage of using a desktop as a media playback device for your TV is great because it lets you connect and access resources on the

internet in real-time. Shoutcast streams are just an example and they are very much like any radio station except in this case, there are thousands of them streaming audio all the time. Think of it as a satellite radio system but there are no subscription rates here.

Listening to internet radio stations is simple. Go to Listen to Music (if you are using the MediaStream theme) and then to Add Source. If this takes you to the music collection window that you already added, you can go back to the root folder by right-clicking here and clicking on Go to Root. To add the stations, click on Add Source and then go to Browse. Scroll down to Shoutcast and press Enter. The next menu you see is the entire database of genres available. Choose the Genre you want to add or press OK if you want to add all the genres. Click OK again.

Now from the root of the Music menu, go to Shoutcast and select a genre. Choose one of the many radio stations and the stream will start playing. The volume can be controlled by pressing the + and - keys.



XBMC can list and play Shoutcast streams over the Internet

Setting up the weather panel

XBMC has a nice little feature which lets you see current weather for different places. Weather is updated all the time and all you

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